COLLEGE DE PARIS SUPERIEUR

Session 2: Explaining & Defending

Bachelor 3 – English for IT Professionals



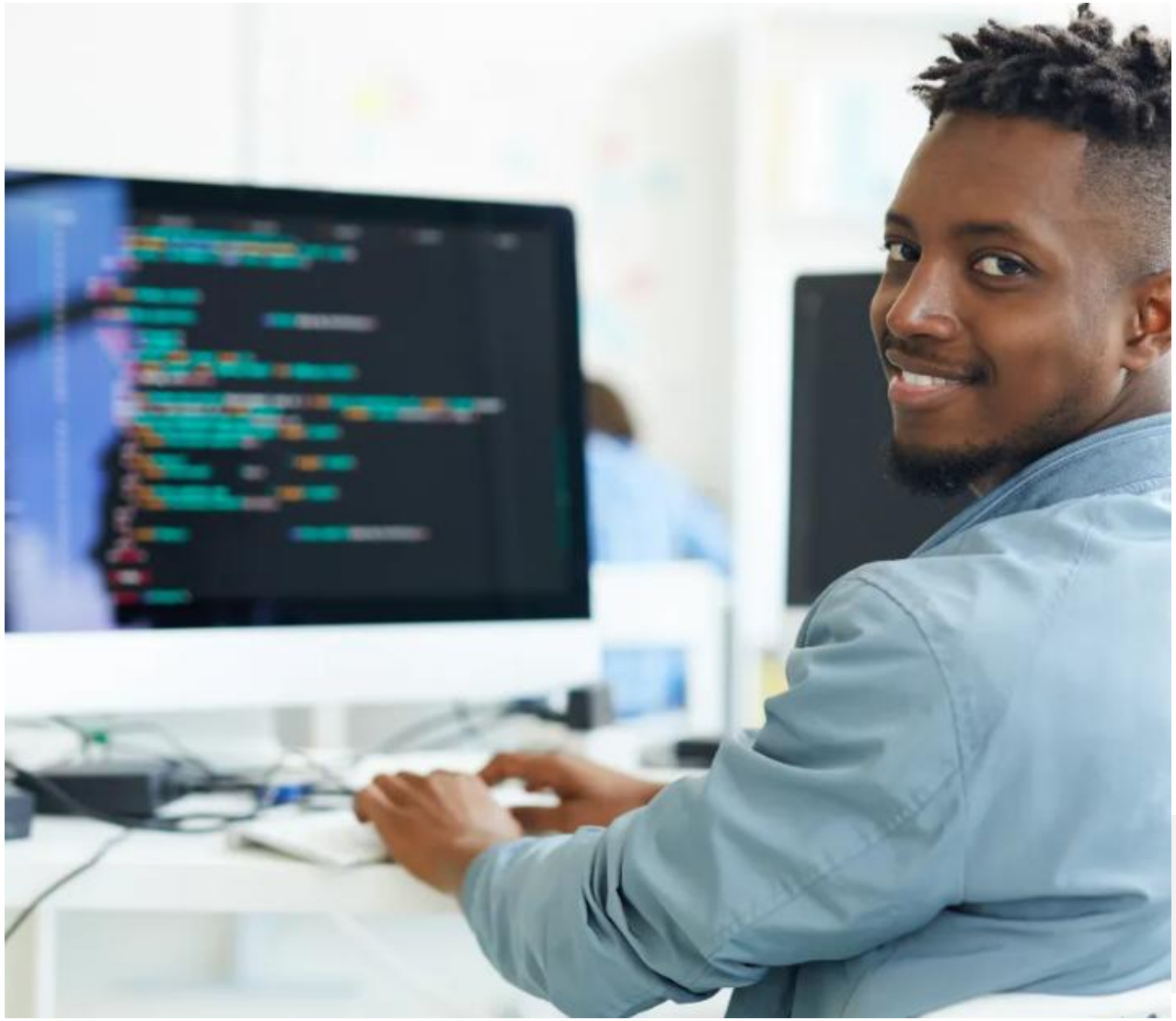
Dorcas Tchogoue

Meetings, Support & Presenting Your Ideas



"The Story of the Perfect System That Nobody Could Use"

Meet Leo …













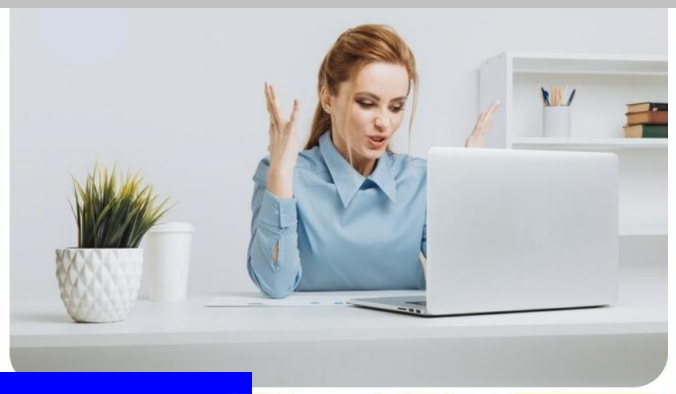


“We use JWT tokens with a nonce to prevent replay attacks…”





“Invalid or malformed claims in token payload.”





“My password is wrong.”










confused

❌ “Sanitize inputs to prevent XSS.”

✅ “Make sure hackers can’t use the comment box to attack other users.”

❌ “Error 403: Authorization Failure.”

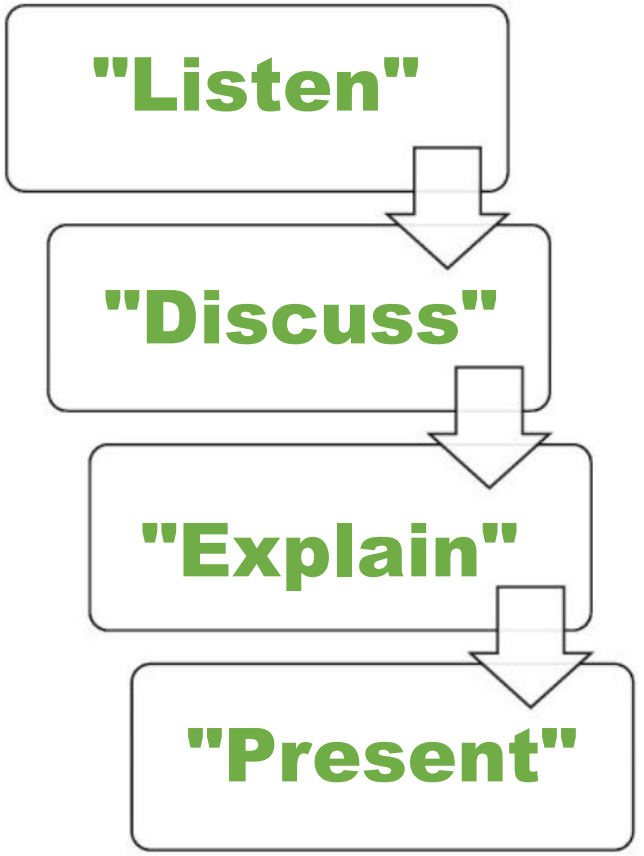
✅ “You don’t have permission to view this page. Contact your administrator.”



SESSION 2: Explaining & Defending

Roadmap & Objectives:

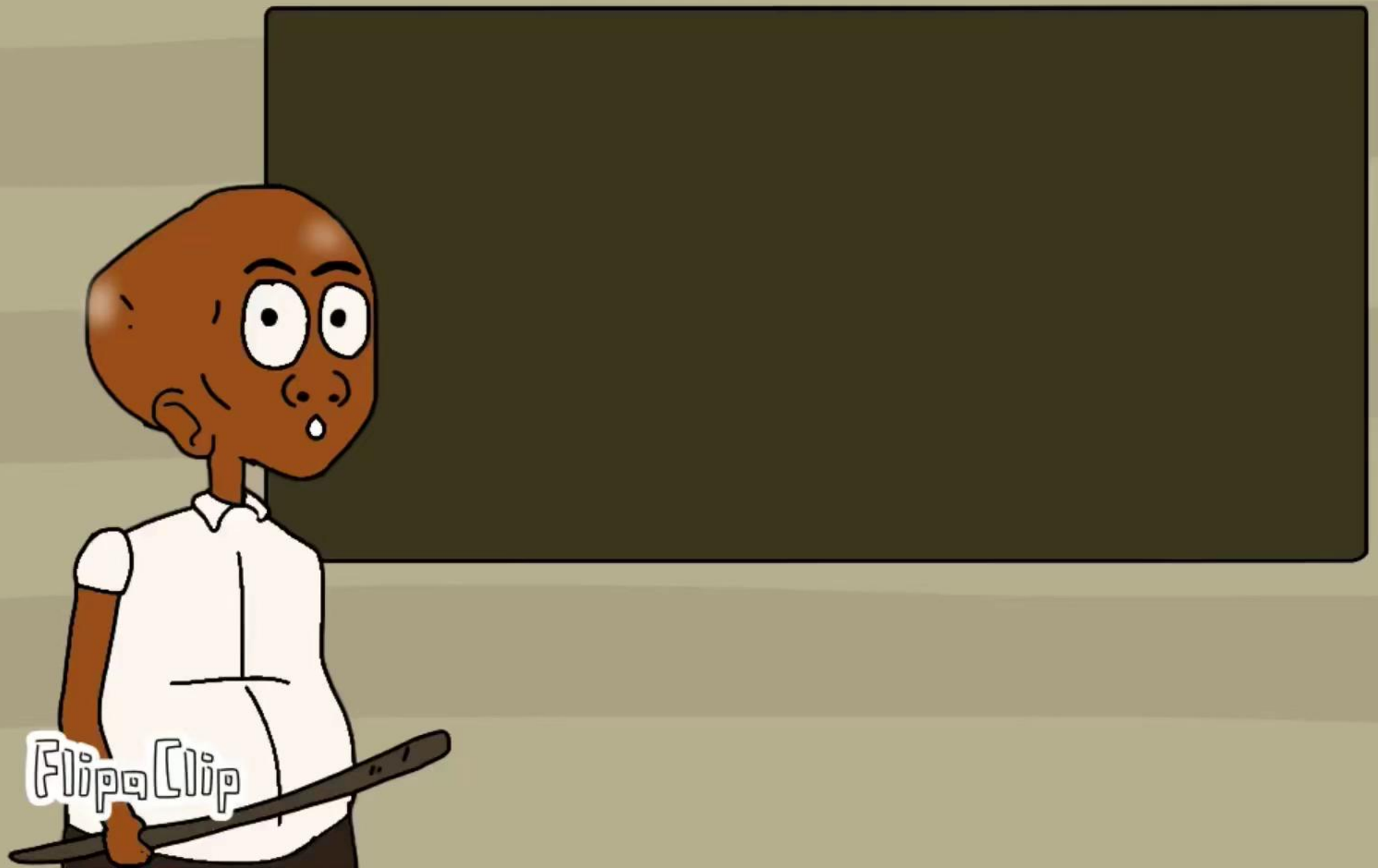
1. **Decode** spoken tech English from tutorials and talks.
2. **Navigate** and participate in a project meeting.
3. **Handle** a user support scenario with clarity and empathy.
4. **Structure** the outline of a technical presentation.



Warm-up: "Tech Tongue Twisters"



@Funimation ug



"Tongue Twisters"

- She sells seashells by the seashore.
- "Betty bought a bit of butter, but the butter was so bitter, so she bought some better butter to make the bitter butter better".
- Peter Piper picked a peck of pickled peppers;
  A peck of pickled peppers Peter Piper picked;
  If Peter Piper picked a peck of pickled peppers,Where’s the peck of pickled peppers Peter Piper picked?

Activity: Listen & Repeat

"Tech Tongue Twisters"

- "The unique database requires a secure query."
- "She sells SaaS solutions on the C2C marketplace."



Listening - Understanding Technical Spoken English

Strategies for Listening:



- **Listen for Signposts:**
  "The main issue is...", "On the other hand...", "To sum up..."

- **Focus on Numbers & Dates:**
  "We're targeting **Q3** for launch." "The error rate spiked to **2.5%**."

- **Identify the Purpose:**
  Is it a tutorial (*how to*), a conference talk (*ideas*), or a stand-up (*status*)?

Listening Exercise - The Stand-up Meeting



What's the Block? Decoding a Stand-up

Exercise: Answer in pairs:

1. What did she do yesterday?
2. Why is she blocked?
3. What is her plan?





Vocabulary & Phrases for Meetings



Meeting Toolkit: From Passive to Active Participant	
Clarifying:	"Could you elaborate on...?"
	"So, if I understand correctly..."
Interrupting Politely:	"Sorry to jump in, but..."
	"If I may add something..."
Stating Opinion:	"From a development perspective, I think..."
	"I'm concerned about the timeline because..."
Managing:	"Let's get back on track."
	"Can we take that offline?"

Interactive Activity
"The Awkward Meeting" Role-Play



Save This Meeting! Role-Play

Activity: In groups of 4. Assign roles:
A: Rambler (goes off-topic),
B: Clarifier (uses phrases to clarify),
C: Redirector (uses phrases to get back on track),
D: Note-taker. The Rambler starts describing a "server issue" but gets lost in irrelevant details.

The others must use the meeting phrases to steer the conversation to a solution. Rotate roles.

Goal: Practice managing real-time conversation.



User Support - The Language of Help

- Support Communication: Empathy + Precision = Success



The Golden Rules:	
Acknowledge & Empathize:	**"I understand this is frustrating."**
	"Thank you for your patience."
Clarify the Problem:	**"Is the error message still appearing?"**
	"Can you describe what happens when you click 'submit'?"
Explain Clearly & Simply:	**Not "The DNS might be propagating," but**
	"The update can take up to 24 hours to work everywhere."

Support Scenario - "The Angry User"



Calm the Storm: Practice Scenario

Scenario Script (For Pairs):

User: "This new interface is terrible! I can't find the report button anymore. I've wasted an hour! I need it NOW for my meeting!"
Support Agent: [you must formulate a response using **Acknowledge, Clarify, Reassure**].
Example Starter: *"I'm sorry to hear you're having trouble, especially before a meeting. Let me help you find it quickly. Can you tell me what you see on your main screen?"*



Pronunciation & Tone
The Power of Your Voice

- It's Not What You Say, It's How You Say It.

Activity: Say this sentence with three different tones:

"The system is down." (Panicked) vs. (Bored) vs. (Calm & Informative).

Key: In support and meetings, a calm, steady, confident tone builds trust, even when delivering bad news.

Introduction to Technical Presentations



The Presentation Map (Problem-Solution):

1. **Title & Hook:** Grab attention with a question or surprising fact.
2. **Agenda:** "Today, I'll cover the problem, our proposed solution, and the next steps."
3. **The Problem:** Make it relatable. Use data.
4. **The Solution/Proposal:** The "what" and "why."
5. **Details/Technical Deep Dive (Optional):** For technical audiences.
6. **Conclusion & Q&A:** Recap and call to action.

Presentation Language - Signposting

- **Starting:** "Today, I'd like to talk about..."
- **Moving On:** "Now, let's turn to..."
  "This brings me to my next point..."
- **Referring Back:** "As I mentioned earlier..."
- **Concluding:** "To wrap up..."
  "In conclusion, the key takeaway is..."
- **Handling Q&A:**
  "That's an excellent question. To my knowledge..."



Examples of signposting in presentations

- A signpost is a marker indicating where you are in your presentation or where you are going.

Stage	Examples Phrases
Introduction	**“I’ll start by reviewing ...”, “First of all, i’ll ...”**
Middle Body	**“The next issue I’d like to focus on is ...”, “Another important aspect is ...”**
Handling Questions	**“I’m happy to answer any questions now ...”, “I’ll come back to that later ...”**
Conclusion	**“That brings me to the end of my talk”, “Just to recap briefly ...”**

In-class Activity

Topic: choose a favorite local business (restaurant, gym, shop) to present to the class.

Ex: how to make a sandwich?

1. Outline a 2-min presentation and incorporate at least 5 differents signposts.
2. Presentation and checklist
3. Peer review and feedback



Categories to include:

- **Introducing the structure**:

"I've divided my talk into three parts ..."

- **Moving to a new section:**

"Now let's turn our attention to ..."

- **Giving Examples:**

"To illustrate this point..." , :A good example of this is..."

- **Referring Back/ Forward:**

"As I mentioned earlier ..."

- **Summarizing / Concluding:**

"To recap briefly..." or "That brings me to the enf of..."

Group Work Part 1 - The Status Meeting

Task 1: The Weekly Sync Meeting

Run a Professional Project Update.



🎯Your Task: The 5-Minute Project Sync

Your team is working on Project Phoenix: Cloud Migration.
Hold a quick meeting where each person gives their update.

⏱️ Time: 5 minutes total for the meeting.

👥Assign These Roles (in your group of 4)

- Project Lead – Runs the meeting. Asks for updates, identifies blockers, assigns tasks.
- Dev 1 – Working on moving the database to the cloud.
- Dev 2 – Working on updating the application configuration.
- QA Tester – Testing the migrated application for bugs.

What Each Person Says (Use these phrases!)

Project Lead (Starts the meeting):

"Okay team, let's get started. Quick update from everyone."
"[Name], what did you work on yesterday? Any blockers?"
"So our main blocker is [security approval]. [Name], can you follow up on that?"
"Great. Let's keep the momentum. Same time tomorrow."



Dev 1 / Dev 2 / QA (When it's your turn):

"Yesterday, I worked on [your task]."
"Today, I will work on [next task]."
"My blocker is…" / "I'm blocked by…" / "No blockers."

Scenario Details for Each Role

Dev 1: You finished testing the database backup. You are blocked because you need the security team's approval to move real data.

Dev 2: You updated 80% of the config files. No blockers. Today you will finish the last 20%.

QA Tester: You found 5 small bugs in the test environment. You are not blocked, but you need Dev 2 to finish the configs before you can test more.

Project Lead: You know the security approval is late. This is the main blocker for the project.

Group Work Part 2 - The Presentation Outline

Activity: Now, as a group, create a 4-slide outline for the presentation to department heads.

Slide 1: Title & Hook (Why migrate? Cost? Security?)

Slide 2: The Problem with the Current System (Risks, costs)

Slide 3: Our Proposed Cloud Solution (Benefits, high-level plan)

Slide 4: Timeline, Investment, & Next Steps

Write the titles and 2-3 bullet points per slide.



Review and Reflection

- What have you learned today?
- Share one thing you learned and how you will apply it





Key Takeaways & "Pro-Tip" of the Day



- Listen for signposts and key details.
- Meetings need active participation and management.
- Support = Empathy + Clear Language.
- Every presentation tells a story (Problem -> Solution).

➢ *Pro-Tip: "In a meeting, if you don't understand, at least three others don't either. Be the one who asks."*

Next lesson:
The Deep Dive & Your Final Presentation.

YOU will deliver a short technical presentation. Start thinking about a simple IT topic you could explain in 5 minutes (e.g., 'What is an API?', 'How does HTTPS work?')."



Homework



1. Listening & Analysis: Watch the first 5 minutes of a conference talk from a channel like Google I/O, or a TED Talk on tech. Write down:
- The speaker's main objective.
- Three signpost phrases they used.
- One technical term you heard and its context.

2. Presentation Prep: prepare your topic and post your presentation for your final assessment.

Instruction: To be completed in your notebook before next class.
Note: This work is compulsory.
Students without completed homework at the start of class will receive a 2-mark deduction.

Final Assessment's Topics

🎯 30 IT presentations Topics (1-Minute Explanation):

Cybersecurity & Networks:

1. What is Phishing, and how can you spot it?
2. Explain how a VPN keeps your data safe on public Wi-Fi.
3. What is the difference between HTTP and HTTPS?
4. What is a DDoS attack in simple terms?
5. Why should you use a Password Manager?

Development & DevOps:

6. What is an API? (Use a simple analogy like a waiter in a restaurant).
7. What is GitHub, and what is it used for?
8. Explain the concept of "Open Source" software.
9. What is Agile Methodology in one sentence?
10. What is a "Bug" in programming, and why is it called that?

Final Assessment's Topics

🎯 IT presentations Topics (1-Minute Explanation):

Concepts & Trends:

11. What is "The Cloud"? Is it just someone else's computer?
12. Explain Blockchain without talking about cryptocurrency.
13. What is Artificial Intelligence (AI) vs. Machine Learning (ML)?
14. What is Big Data, and why is it "big"?
15. What is the "Internet of Things" (IoT) in your home?

Hardware & Basics:

16. What is the difference between RAM and Storage (HDD/SSD)?
17. How does a solid-state drive (SSD) make a computer faster?
18. What is the purpose of a motherboard?
19. Explain what a "server" is to a 10-year-old.
20. What is the difference between a web browser and a search engine?

Final Assessment's Topics

🎯 IT presentations Topics (1-Minute Explanation):

User Experience & Professional Practice:

21. What is the difference between UI (User Interface) and UX (User Experience)?
22. Why is "CTRL + S" (Save) the most important shortcut?
23. What does "IT Support" actually do?
24. What is "Technical Debt"?
25. Explain the importance of "Backing Up" your data.

Fun & Analogies:

26. Explain how the Internet works using a postal service analogy.
27. Describe what a "Firewall" is using a castle analogy.
28. What is "Spam" email, and why is it called that?
29. Explain what "Cookies" are on a website (not the edible kind!).
30. What is "Bandwidth" using a highway/traffic analogy?

YOUR 1- MINUTE STRUCTURE



- **Hook** (10 seconds): "Have you ever wondered how...?" or "Today, I'll explain [TOPIC] in one minute."
- **Core Explanation** (40 seconds): Give the main idea. USE ONE SIMPLE ANALOGY or EXAMPLE. Avoid complex jargon. If you use a technical term, explain it immediately.
- **Example**: "An API is like a waiter in a restaurant. You (the user) give your order (request) to the waiter, who takes it to the kitchen (the server), and then brings your food (the response) back to you."
- **Conclusion & Takeaway** (10 seconds): Summarize in one sentence. "So, in short, an API is a messenger that allows different applications to talk to each other."

Recorded Speeches

- Record 1-minute video speech
- The teacher reviews outside class time
- Best 10 present live to class





GRADING SCALE - SPEAKING

(20 Points Total)

Criteria	Excellent (Full Marks)	Good
A. Content (10 pts)		
Clear Hook & Intro (4)	Topic is clear from the first 10 seconds.	Topic is clear but intro is weak.
Logical Structure (3)	Follows a perfect "Hook-Explanation-Conclusion" flow	Structure is mostly clear.
Simple Language & Analogy (3)	Uses excellent, simple analogy. No unexplained jargon.	Explanation is clear but could be simpler.
B. Delivery (10 pts)		
Timing & Pace (3)	55-60 seconds. Perfect, calm pace.	50-65 seconds. Pace is slightly too fast/slow.
Fluency & Confidence (3)	Very fluent, almost no filler words ("um", "like"). Sounds confident.	Some filler words or pauses, but generally fluent.
Pronunciation & Tone (2)	All words, especially technical terms, are clear. Engaging tone.	Mostly clear pronunciation. Tone is acceptable.
C. Professionalism (2 pts)	Perfect format, relevant topic, highly polished.	Correct format, topic is relevant.

Some valuable resources:

Books & Textbooks:

1. Books on Professional Communication:

"Talk Like TED: The 9 Public-Speaking Secrets of the World's Top Minds" by Carmine Gallo.

2. Online Listening & Practice Resources:

Podcasts for Immersion:

"Software Engineering Daily": In-depth interviews on technical topics. Excellent for listening to structured, technical conversations.

"Darknet Diaries": Story-driven podcasts about cybercrime and hacking. Highly engaging; fantastic for listening comprehension and picking up security vocabulary in a narrative context.

"The Stack Overflow Podcast": Discussions on developer life and tech trends. Good for casual, conversational tech English.

YouTube Channels:

"Fireship": Very short (1-2 min), high-energy explanations of tech concepts. Great for seeing how to explain something complex quickly and clearly.

Preview of Session 3

- Summarize a complex technical text,
- Draft the core of a professional summary report.



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Thank you!



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